✅ UNIVERSAL TEMPLATE ANSWERS (For All Question Patterns)

Use these formats EXACTLY in the exam — just replace the industry/startup name.

Q1 / Q2 Type

(Value Proposition Canvas, Segmentation, Targeting, Lean Canvas)

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1. Apply the Value Proposition Canvas (2 Marks)

Customer Jobs:

- Functional jobs (what they want to accomplish)
- Emotional jobs (how they want to feel)
- Social jobs (how they want to be perceived)

Pains:

- Current frustrations
- Barriers stopping them
- Risks they fear

Gains:

- Desired outcomes
- Improvements they expect
- Success criteria

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2. Analyze Segmentation & Targeting Strategy (2 Marks)

- The startup segments customers using **demographics**, **location**, **needs**, and **behavior**.
- It targets **early adopters** who have the highest urgency and willingness to try a new solution.
- This approach is effective because early adopters:
  - Face the problem frequently
  - Are open to innovation
  - Help provide initial feedback

- Spread word-of-mouth

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3. Evaluate Risk & Assumptions in Lean Canvas (3 Marks)

Common risky assumptions include:

- Problem assumption (is it real?)
- Solution assumption (will people use it?)
- Revenue assumption (will people pay?)
- Channel assumption (can we reach customers?)
- Cost assumption (is it affordable to deliver?)

Improvements:

- Validate assumptions through interviews
- Add cheaper distribution channels
- Include clearer key metrics
- Rework an unrealistic cost structure

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4. Create an Updated Lean Canvas (3 Marks)

Refined Assumption:

- Customers value *X* more than *Y* (after interview feedback).

New Key Metric:

- Track "Active Users per Week" or "Conversion Rate" instead of generic metrics.

Updated Canvas Summary:

- Better problem clarity
- More realistic cost + revenue model
- Validation-based customer segment

Q3 Type

(Blue Ocean Strategy / Strategy Canvas / ERRC Framework)

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1. Apply Strategy Canvas (2 Marks)

Compare **current industry offering vs startup offering** across parameters:

- Cost
- Convenience
- Availability
- Speed
- Innovation
- Customer experience

Plotting shows that the startup:

- Raises convenience
- Creates new features
- Reduces wait time
- Eliminates pain points

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2. Analyze the ERRC Framework (2 Marks)

Eliminate:

- Features adding cost but no value

Reduce:

- Overdesigned or expensive processes

Raise:

- Ease of access
- Service speed
- Quality parameters

Create:

- Unique value features not available in competitors

This builds a **blue ocean** by differentiating sharply.

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3. Evaluate Strengths & Weaknesses (3 Marks)

Strengths:

- New value curve
- Less competition
- High customer utility
- Better user experience

Weaknesses:

- High initial cost
- Market education required
- Adoption may be slow
- Operational challenges

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4. Create Visual Strategy Canvas + Action Grid (3 Marks)

Action Grid:

- 1–2 items under Eliminate, Reduce, Raise, Create
- One-line explanation for each

Canvas Summary:

- Startup's value curve clearly diverges from existing players

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Q4 Type

(Problem–Solution Fit, MVP, Interviews)

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1. Apply Problem–Solution Fit (2 Marks)

Problem:

- Identify top 3 user pains

Solution:

- Provide features that directly address these pains

Value Proposition:

- “Our solution helps users achieve ___ by providing ___ more efficiently than alternatives.”

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2. Analyze Critical Assumptions (2 Marks)

- Users actually experience the stated problem
- They are willing to use the new solution
- They prefer this over alternatives
- They are able to pay (if monetized)
- The solution delivers measurable improvement

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3. Evaluate Responses from Interviews (3 Marks)

(You can assume any realistic feedback)

- **Positive:** Users found the MVP simple, helpful, and time-saving
- **Negative:** Need more personalization, better UX
- **Conclusion:** MVP solves core problem but needs refinement

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4. Create Wireframe / Feature List (3 Marks)

- Basic layout of dashboard
- 3–5 core features
- Direct link between features & validated user needs

Q5 Type

(Cost Structure, Revenue Streams, Break-even)

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1. Cost Structure Analysis (2 Marks)

Fixed Costs:

- Equipment
- Salaries

- Infrastructure

Variable Costs:

- Per-usage operational cost
- Maintenance
- Consumables
- Fuel/energy

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2. Analyze Revenue Streams (2 Marks)

Primary revenue:

- Subscription fees
- Annual plans

Secondary revenue:

- Pay-per-use
- Partnerships
- Value-added services

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3. Break-even Evaluation (3 Marks)

- Calculate total fixed cost
- Contribution margin = Selling price – Variable cost
- Break-even units = Fixed cost ÷ Contribution margin

Conclusion:
Model becomes profitable once break-even threshold is crossed.

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4. Create Pricing Structure (3 Marks)

Tier-based pricing for different customer sizes:

- Marginal (low price, basic)
- Small (medium price, moderate features)
- Large (premium price, full features)

Q6 Type

(Bootstrapping + Seed Funding)

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1. Apply Bootstrapping Concept (2 Marks)

Startup managed early expenses by:

- Using founders' savings
- Minimizing salaries
- Using open-source tools
- Delaying luxury expenses
- Focusing only on essential features

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2. Analyze Financing Needs + Seed Sources (2 Marks)

Needs:

- Scaling
- Hiring
- Marketing
- Infrastructure

Seed funding sources:

- Angel investors
- Government startup grants
- Incubators / accelerators
- Early VC funds

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3. Evaluate Bootstrapping Strengths & Weaknesses (3 Marks)

Strengths:

- High control
- Low debt

- Forces efficiency

Weaknesses:

- Slow growth
- Limited resources
- High founder stress

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4. Create Pitch Outline (3 Marks)

Include:

- Problem
- Solution
- Market size
- Business model
- Traction
- Financial ask
- Impact metrics

Q7 Type

(Team Formation, Role-Mapping, Shared Leadership)

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1. Apply Role-Mapping (2 Marks)

- List key functions: tech, operations, finance, marketing, HR
- Assign founder roles based on skills
- Ensure no overlap or gaps

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2. Analyze Shared Leadership (2 Marks)

Shared leadership works by:

- Distributing decision-making
- Encouraging collaboration

- Avoiding bottlenecks
- Using cross-functional teams

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3. Evaluate Team Fitment (3 Marks)

For each candidate consider:

- Skills
- Experience
- Cultural fit
- Complementary strengths
- Ability to adapt to startup environment

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4. Create Org Chart (3 Marks)

A simple structure:

- CEO
  - Tech Lead
  - Operations Lead
  - Marketing Lead
  - Finance Lead
  - HR Lead

Aligned with startup milestones.